CHAPTER 2

FOUR PHASES OF EXTREMISM AND TERRORISM

The current security situation in Pakistan is mainly attributed to its more than a decade-long support to anti-Soviet jihad in Afghanistan and then to the Taliban regime. Pakistan provided not only CIA-backed financial support but also Pakistani manpower to Afghan Mujahedeen. Thousands of Pakistanis participated in the Afghan jihad. Many jihadi and religious parties and a large number of madrasahs grew rapidly as a result. It became a common culture and most Pakistanis believed that the militant struggle in Afghanistan was a legitimate activity and furthermore, they were made to believe that it was their religious and moral duty to support Afghan Mujahedeen or at least be sympathetic towards them.

After the Soviet–Afghan War, Pakistanis returned home with the aim of bringing about a change in Pakistan too. An adverse aftermath was the spread of lethal illegal weapons like the Russian-made Kalashnikov rifle (AK-47) throughout Pakistan. It was termed the Kalashnikov culture, which facilitated organised crimes and armed groups to operate with might. The Pakistanis who fought or supported the war and conflicts at the behest of several states and their own government were left in the lurch and unguided and post-operation care was non-existent. Psychological and physical rehabilitation of trained and battle-hardened fighters to refit them in the society was considered needless. The sympathisers and facilitators